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Applying for: Senior Director, Technology Commercialization, Wayne State University, Detroit, MI

SUMMARY

Commercialization infrastructure built for exactly what this role owns: running a stage-gated portfolio framework, keeping faculty and industry relationships fed with real candidates, and freeing a commercialization team's time from triage so it goes toward license negotiation and startup formation instead.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called "game-changing" from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same "which three patents protect the core product" question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

- Stage-gate portfolio triage: flags which inventions in the docket have real market demand versus which don't, the same call a stage-gated framework depends on at every gate rather than only at intake.
- Licensee and industry-partner discovery: a network of 20M licensing contacts with partner-specific outreach materials generated in about an hour, so feeding faculty and industry relationships with real candidates doesn't start from a cold list every time.
- Portfolio visibility across a full commercialization team: tracks disclosures, IP status, and licensing activity in one place, the kind of visibility tied to as much as a 15% increase in licensing revenue at institutions using it, the team-wide clarity a Senior Director managing both a team and their own portfolio needs.

WHERE I STOP

Leading the commercialization team, mentoring staff, and the license negotiation judgment this role does jointly with the Director of IP & Contracts, that's real leadership and legal judgment I don't have and don't claim to. What I can do is make sure the stage-gate triage and industry-matching underneath those calls isn't the thing eating a Senior Director's hours.